



14 Prepositions



A *preposition* is a word or group of words which is usually placed before a noun or pronoun in a sentence. This is done for various purposes, the most common being to indicate: (i) the *place* where something happens, (ii) the *place* one is coming from or going to/the direction in which somebody or something is moving (*direction*), or (iii) where somebody or something is (*position/location*).

The noun or pronoun before which a preposition is placed is called its *object*:

- (a) The meeting was held in a big hall.

The preposition *in* shows where the meeting was held — the *place* where something happened. The object of the preposition *in* is *hall*.

- (b) The dog was running towards me.

The preposition *towards* shows the *direction* in which the dog was running. The object of the preposition *towards* is the pronoun *me*.

- (c) John's books are on the table.

The preposition *on* indicates the *place* where John's books are. The object of the preposition *on* is *table*.

Many words that are used as *prepositions* can be used as *adverbs* also. If such a word is used with an object, it is a preposition; if not, it is an adverb.

- (d) You should go up.

- (e) You should go up the stairs.

In (d), *up* has no object. So, it is an *adverb*. But in (e), *up* has an object — *stairs* (Q: *up* what? Ans: *stairs*) — and is obviously a preposition.

- A** Point out the **noun** or **pronoun** that is the **object** of each of the underlined **prepositions**. An example is given below to help you.

Mani threw the ball at the wicket.

preposition — at **object** — wicket

1. The key to good health is good habits.
2. The red house on your left is the house which you are looking for.
3. June forgot to take her purse with her and had no money for her bus fare.
4. Astronomers look at the sky year after year, patiently waiting for something new to swim into sight.
5. He is a leader worthy of our respect.
6. A star flashed across the sky, but nobody took any notice of it.
7. According to weather reports, the temperature will drop below zero.
8. You cannot visit another country without a passport.
9. You must produce a medical certificate for your long absence from school.
10. The glass fell from her hand and broke into pieces.

B Fill in the blanks with *appropriate prepositions* 18/12/25 chosen from those given within brackets:

1. I saw a goldfish swimming in..... the bowl.
(in/on)
2. We looked at..... the stars twinkling in.....
the night sky. (at/to; in/on)
3. She put the dishes on..... the table, one in front of..... each guest.
(above/on; at/of)
4. We saw him going towards..... the station. (near/towards)
5. Air is essential to..... life. (to/with)
6. The dog had a collar with..... a name-tag round..... its neck. (to/with;
from/round)
7. He was lying on..... the ground, groaning with..... pain. (in/on;
from/with)
8. The postman pushed the letters under..... the door. (through/under)
9. He is coming from..... London to..... attend the marriage ceremony of
his sister. (from/over; for/to)
10. He made a lot of fuss over..... the invitation cards, but forgot to..... invite
his closest friend. (on/over; about/to)



C Fill in the blanks with appropriate prepositions:

1. Mother looked at..... the photographs in..... the album, with a smile on..... her face.
2. Sita filled the electric kettle with..... water and put the teacups on..... the table.
3. I have never heard of..... such a strange animal before.
4. The clock was placed high above..... the city, so that everybody could look at..... it and never be late for..... anything.
5. Nobody could solve the mystery of..... the missing wristwatch.
6. One must never be cruel to..... animals.
7. The room was decorated with..... balloons and festoons for..... the birthday party.
8. The eyes of..... the little boy were shining with..... joy.
9. We plan to have a party on..... the last day of the term.
10. Tithi is very popular among..... her classmates.
11. She was afraid of..... dogs, but very fond of..... cats.
12. Adil blamed himself for..... the accident.
13. Rishi lives in..... Mumbai, but he often goes to..... Kolkata.
14. Our car broke down on..... the way and we had to walk to..... the station.
15. The girl was sitting on..... the verandah, reading a book.
16. The earth goes around..... the sun once a year.
17. The sons of the king fought among..... themselves for each of them wanted to be the king.
18. The distance between..... the two countries was 7,000 miles.
19. On his way back from..... school, Tushar tripped over..... a small stone and twisted his ankle.
20. The drops of dew that you see in..... the morning on..... the grass and flowers do not fall from..... the sky like rain.

